Modi's office. His assistant, O.P. Singh, would show it to the Gujarat chief minister, who would revert almost instantaneously.

Pandey says that Modi intervened just twice. First, when there was a view that the advertising campaign should emphasize '*Dus Saal Se Bhura Haal*' (Ten years of bad governance). 'I went to tell him that we didn't think it worked, he just said, "*Piyushji, aage badhiye* [carry on],"' recalls Pandey. On another occasion, he was shown a creative with a green line running through at the bottom of every Modi poster. Modi looked at it and changed it to a diagonal line. 'It was actually better than the original,' laughs Pandey.

The campaign highlights once again the centrality of 'Team Modi' and its business-like approach to the campaign. Political campaigns can be notoriously unstructured—king-size egos and internal battles can often be a recipe for chaos. The BJP managed to bring in a strong professional element to their communications strategy and worked in unison.

Manoj Ladwa, a London-born, UK-based lawyer whom Modi trusted implicitly, was in charge of the in-house media research team and had to ensure that all the messaging went out smoothly. The forty-one-year-old Ladwa had met Modi through the Gujarati NRI network in the 1990s, and despite the age difference, had struck an instant rapport. He had also lobbied for Modi with the British government after the 2002 riots. Another Modi man from Gujarat, Vijay Chauthaiwale, who was a molecular biologist and an ABVP activist, handled the back-room operations and coordinated between the Delhi and Gandhinagar war rooms. Ajay Singh, who had worked closely on the India Shining campaign with Pramod Mahajan in 2004, was a key figure in the media buying and planning. Piyush Goyal was the man for all seasons, a crisis manager and the one who controlled the money flow. Shah was the political ideas man. Jaitley was the final word on the creatives.

'We soon realized that we were not dealing with any other political party, but one that was following a professional work ethic that even most corporates could not match,' says Sam Balsara, chairman and managing director of Madison. The respect is mutual. Goyal gives Madison 'eleven out of ten' for the media plan.